

sity sites, and.com,.org, and.net domains can be purchased and may be sources of fake news.

- **Coverage:** External links to verifiable sources should be included on the website to back up factual claims. Coverage is incomplete and may be untrustworthy if the site solely links to its own pages and the infrequent external connection goes to a low-authority, suspicious site.
- **Timeliness:** The website should state when content was produced and published, as well as whether or not it has been updated. Links to current and relevant information sources should be included.
- **Objectivity:** The website's objectiveness should be stated clearly. The "About" section of a website should tell you everything you need to know about it.
- **Accuracy:** The website's factual assertions should be able to be independently verified. When you examine factual statements against independent sources, they should hold up.

Because you must perform research to verify a website's authenticity, it can be difficult. However, it is far preferable to do the extra effort than to accept a website's assertions as true.

Steps to fact-check

Below, you'll find some simple questions that you can ask to separate the wheat from the chaff.

Is the statement true?

First, analyse the statement itself: does it seem plausible or reasonable to you? Although breaking news can be frightening or unexpected, a headline should be plausible. Suspicious assertions concerning public persons, politics, and the nature of reality should be avoided. Try not to believe everything you read or to think something is true just because it was written by someone. It's likely that an article is false news if it sounds far-fetched.

Is this a well-known news organisation or a well-known news website?

What website or organisation are you getting your information from? Is it a reliable news organisation like The New York Times, NPR, or Reuters? Is it a brand-new website that you've never heard of? Check the website's URL once more: Sites ending in.edu and.gov are more trustworthy because they are reserved for educational institutions and government agencies.